

Absolutely — **food** is a useful family/polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “With **food businesses**, people may try a place once out of curiosity...”

Here **food** means **things people eat**, especially as the main product category of the business. The word itself is not extremely polysemous, but it has several important extensions and compounds worth mapping carefully.

Word family: **food / foodie / foodstuff**

Base word: food

Related noun: foodie

Related noun: foodstuff

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Meaning in your passage: **food** = edible things as a business category — 食物；食品

Your phrase:

> “food businesses”

Here **food** means:

> **products intended to be eaten**, especially when considered as a commercial category.

繁體中文：

供人食用的食物 / 食品，這裡是指餐飲、烘焙等與食物有關的商業類別

Natural translation:

> “With food businesses...”

「對**餐飲 / 食品業**來說.....」

So here:

> **food** = 食物產品這個商業類別

1. **food** = things people or animals eat — 食物

The core meaning.

Practice 1 — Original sense

> “Quality matters in **food businesses**.”

「對**餐飲 / 食品業**來說，品質很重要。」

Practice 2

> “The café serves simple **food**.”

「這間咖啡店供應簡單的**食物**。」

Practice 3

> “We bought enough food for the weekend.”

「我們買了足夠週末吃的**食物**。」

food = 人或動物吃進身體、用來提供營養或能量的東西

2. **food** = a particular type/style of cuisine — 菜式；飲食

A very common contextual extension.

Practice 4

> “I love Italian **food**.”

「我很喜歡**意大利菜**。」

Practice 5

> “The restaurant serves traditional local food.”

「這間餐廳供應傳統**本地菜式**。」

food = 某個國家、地區或文化的菜式 / 飲食

Here Chinese is often not simply 「食物」 but:

- * 菜
- * 菜式
- * 飲食

3. **food = nourishment / source of sustenance — 養分；營養來源**

A broader biological meaning.

Practice 6

> “Plants make their own **food** through photosynthesis.”

「植物透過光合作用製造自己的**養分**。」

Practice 7

> “The young birds depend on their parents for food.”

「幼鳥依靠父母提供**食物 / 養分**。」

food = 能供生物攝取能量或營養的物質

In biology, the Chinese translation may shift toward:

* 養分

* 營養來源

4. **food = something that stimulates thought/feeling — 精神食糧；啟發思考的材料**

A figurative meaning.

Practice 8

> “The book gave me plenty of **food for thought**.”

「這本書給了我很多**值得思考的材料**。」

Practice 9

> “Her comments provided food for further discussion.”

「她的評論為進一步討論提供了不少**思考素材**。」

food — figurative = 能供思想、想像或討論吸收的材料

The most important expression is:

> **food for thought** = 值得深思的內容 / 發人深省的材料

5. **food = products considered commercially — 食品**

A business/regulatory use.

Practice 10

> “The company produces frozen **food**.”

「這間公司生產冷凍**食品**。」

Practice 11

> “Food prices have risen.”

「**食品價格**上升了。」

food = 作為商品、生產類別或市場類別的食品

This is especially common in:

* food industry

* food prices

* food production

* food safety

6. **food industry = 食品業；餐飲食品產業**

Practice 12

> “She has worked in the **food industry** for ten years.”

「她在**食品業 / 餐飲業**工作了十年。」

Practice 13

> “Technology is changing the food industry.”

「科技正在改變**食品產業**。」

****food industry = 涉及食品生產、加工、分銷、銷售或餐飲服務的產業****

7. ****food business = 食品業者；餐飲生意****

This is directly relevant to your passage.

Practice 14

> “Running a ****food business**** requires strict quality control.”

「經營****餐飲 / 食品生意****需要嚴格控制品質。」

Practice 15

> “Small food businesses depend heavily on repeat customers.”

「小型****餐飲企業****很依賴回頭客。」

****food business = 以製作、出售或供應食物為主要業務的企業****

8. ****food safety = 食品安全****

A very common compound.

Practice 16

> “The bakery follows strict ****food safety**** rules.”

「這間麵包店遵守嚴格的****食品安全****規定。」

Practice 17

> “Food safety is essential in restaurants.”

「對餐廳來說，****食品安全****非常重要。」

****food safety = 確保食品不受污染、適合食用的制度與標準****

9. ****food poisoning = 食物中毒****

Practice 18

> “Several customers reported **food poisoning**.”

「幾名顧客報告出現**食物中毒**。」

Practice 19

> “Proper storage helps prevent food poisoning.”

「正確儲存食物有助預防**食物中毒**。」

food poisoning = 吃下受污染食物後引起的疾病

10. **food waste** = 食物浪費；廚餘

A common modern compound.

Practice 20

> “The bakery is trying to reduce **food waste**.”

「這間麵包店正努力減少**食物浪費 / 廚餘**。」

Practice 21

> “Unsold bread can create a lot of food waste.”

「賣不出的麵包可能造成大量**食物浪費**。」

food waste = 被丟棄、未食用或浪費掉的食物

Context:

* 食物浪費 = phenomenon

* 廚餘 = discarded food material

11. **comfort food** = 療癒食物；令人有安慰感的食物

A useful compound, especially relevant to your passage’s “comfort”.

Practice 22

> “Soup is my favourite **comfort food**.”

「湯是我最喜歡的**療癒食物 / 安慰食物**。」

Practice 23

> “Fresh bread can feel like comfort food.”

「新鮮麵包可以給人一種**療癒食物**的感覺。」

comfort food = 讓人因熟悉、味道或回憶而感到安慰和滿足的食物

12. **junk food = 垃圾食物；高糖高脂低營養食品**

Practice 24

> “He is trying to eat less **junk food**.”

「他正努力少吃**垃圾食物**。」

Practice 25

> “Junk food is often high in salt, sugar, or fat.”

「**垃圾食物**通常含較高的鹽、糖或脂肪。」

junk food = 營養價值較低、通常高糖高脂高鹽的加工食物

13. **fast food = 快餐；快餐食品**

Practice 26

> “The area has several **fast-food** restaurants.”

「這一帶有幾間**快餐店**。」

Practice 27

> “Fast food is designed to be prepared quickly.”

「**快餐**的設計重點是能快速準備。」

****fast food = 快速製作及供應的餐飲食品****

14. ****whole food / whole foods = 天然完整食物；少加工食品****

Practice 28

> “She prefers ****whole foods**** to highly processed snacks.”

「她比較喜歡****天然完整食物 / 少加工食物****，而不是高度加工零食。」

Practice 29

> “Whole foods are usually minimally processed.”

「****天然完整食物****通常加工程度較低。」

****whole foods = 接近天然原貌、加工較少的食物****

15. ****baby food = 嬰兒食品****

Practice 30

> “The shop sells organic ****baby food****.”

「這間店出售有機****嬰兒食品****。」

Practice 31

> “Baby food should be easy to swallow.”

「****嬰兒食品****應該容易吞嚥。」

16. ****pet food = 寵物食品****

Practice 32

> “The store sells premium ****pet food****.”

「這間店出售高級****寵物食品****。」

Practice 33

> “Pet food must be stored properly.”

「**寵物食品**必須妥善儲存。」

17. **foodie = 美食愛好者；吃貨**

A common informal family extension.

Practice 34

> “The bakery has become popular with **foodies**.”

「這間麵包店開始很受**美食愛好者**歡迎。」

Practice 35

> “She is a real foodie and loves trying new restaurants.”

「她真的是個**吃貨 / 美食愛好者**，很喜歡試新餐廳。」

foodie = 對食物、餐廳和飲食文化特別有興趣的人

Register:

* informal

* positive or playful

18. **foodstuff = 食品；食材**

A formal/technical related noun.

Practice 36

> “The warehouse stores dry **foodstuffs**.”

「這個倉庫儲存乾燥**食品 / 食材**。」

Practice 37

> “Basic foodstuffs became more expensive.”

「基本**食品**變得更昂貴。」

foodstuff = 作為商品或原料來看待的食物；正式用語

Register:

* formal

* commercial/regulatory

Important distinction: **food vs meal**

food

= the substance/items eaten.

meal

= an eating occasion or set of dishes.

> “There is plenty of food.”

> = 有很多食物。

> “We had a good meal.”

> = 我們吃了一頓好飯。

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **food vs dish**

food

broad category.

dish

one prepared item/course.

> Italian food

> = 意大利菜

> a pasta dish
> = 一道意粉菜式

Important distinction: **food vs cuisine**

food

ordinary, broad.

cuisine

= a developed cooking tradition/style.

> Japanese food

> = 日本菜

> Japanese cuisine

> = 日本料理 / 日本飲食文化

cuisine sounds more formal and systematic.

Important distinction: **food vs ingredient**

food

= edible item/product.

ingredient

= component used to make a dish/product.

> bread is food

> flour is an ingredient in bread

So:

* food = 食物

* ingredient = 食材 / 材料

Important distinction: **food vs groceries**

food

= edible items themselves.

groceries

= food and other household items bought from a shop/supermarket.

> buy food

> = 買食物

> buy groceries

> = 買日常雜貨 / 食品

Important distinction: **food vs feed**

food

normally for humans and animals generally.

feed

often specifically food given to farm animals.

> dog food

> = 狗糧

> cattle feed

> = 牛隻飼料

Important distinction: **food — countable or uncountable?**

Usually **food** is uncountable:

> “We need more food.”

But **foods** is possible when referring to:

> different types/categories of food

Example:

> “Fermented foods are popular.”

「發酵**食品種類**很受歡迎。」

So:

* food = 食物整體

* foods = 不同種類的食品

This is an important lexical/grammar distinction.

Important distinction: **food vs foods**

food

> “Healthy food is important.”

= 健康飲食 / 健康食物很重要。

foods

> “These foods are high in fibre.”

= 這些不同**食品 / 食物種類**纖維含量高。

Plural **foods** is not wrong; it means types/items considered separately.

Important distinction: **food business vs restaurant**

food business

broader:

* bakery

* restaurant

* caterer

* food producer

* takeaway

* food retailer

restaurant

one specific type of food business.

So in your passage, **food businesses** is intentionally broader than “restaurants”.

Important distinction: **food industry vs catering industry**

food industry

very broad:

production, processing, distribution, retail, restaurants, etc.

catering industry

more specifically:

preparing and serving meals/drinks.

Important distinction: **comfort food vs healthy food**

These categories can overlap, but they describe different things.

comfort food

= emotional comfort

healthy food

= nutritional quality

A food can be both, either, or neither.

Important distinction: **food for thought**

This is figurative.

> “That gives us food for thought.”

does **not** mean edible food.

It means:

> **值得進一步思考的事情 / 材料**

This is probably the strongest figurative extension of **food**.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **food — edible substance** = 食物
- * **food — cuisine** = 菜式 / 飲食
- * **food — biological nourishment** = 養分 / 營養來源
- * **food — commercial product category** = 食品
- * **food for thought** = 值得思考的材料
- * **food industry** = 食品業 / 餐飲食品產業
- * **food business** = 餐飲 / 食品生意
- * **food safety** = 食品安全
- * **food poisoning** = 食物中毒
- * **food waste** = 食物浪費 / 廚餘
- * **comfort food** = 療癒食物 / 安慰食物
- * **junk food** = 垃圾食物
- * **fast food** = 快餐
- * **whole foods** = 天然完整 / 少加工食物
- * **baby food** = 嬰兒食品
- * **pet food** = 寵物食品
- * **foodie** = 美食愛好者 / 吃貨
- * **foodstuff** = 食品 / 食材

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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food — general	人或動物攝取以獲得營養 / 能量的可食用物質
food — cuisine	某國家、地區或文化的菜式 / 飲食
food — nourishment	為生物提供能量或營養的物質
food — commercial	作為生產、銷售或市場類別的食品
food for thought	能引發進一步思考或討論的內容
food business	以製作、出售或供應食物為主要業務的企業
food industry	涉及食品生產、加工、分銷、銷售及餐飲的產業
food safety	確保食品不受污染、適合食用的制度與標準
food waste	被丟棄、未食用或浪費掉的食物
comfort food	因熟悉、味道或回憶而令人感到安慰的食物

foods	被分開看待的不同食物種類	
foodie	對食物、餐廳及飲食文化特別有興趣的人	
foodstuff	作為商品 / 原料來看待的食品或食材	

For your original sentence

> “With ****food businesses****, people may try a place once out of curiosity, but they only come back if the standard stays high.”

The exact meaning is:

****food** = 食物 / 食品作為商業產品類別；**food businesses** 指麵包店、餐廳、咖啡店、食品店等以製作或售賣食物為主要業務的生意。 ******

Natural translation:

> ******「對餐飲 / 食品業來說，人們可能因好奇而試一次，但只有當品質一直維持高水準，他們才會再回來。」 ******

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****food**** → 食物
- > ****Italian food**** → 意大利菜
- > ****food as nourishment**** → 養分
- > ****food business**** → 餐飲 / 食品生意
- > ****food industry**** → 食品業
- > ****food for thought**** → 值得深思的材料
- > ****comfort food**** → 療癒食物
- > ****food vs foods**** → 食物整體 vs 不同食品種類
- > ****food vs meal**** → 食物本身 vs 一頓飯